posta

BRAND AND DESIGN SYSTEM · V1 · 25 OCTOBER 2026

Warm, flat, and quiet enough to be trusted.

Direction C “Phone First”. One colour field, one accent, three type sizes per screen. The whole point of this system is that it is smaller than the one it replaces — the old interface stacked gradients, glass, glow and six accents, which is why it read as busy.

11	4	3	1	0
official languages	platforms	type sizes per view	accent, once per screen	gradients

COLOUR

Five colours, and every ratio measured

--posta-clay
#8E3B2E
Brand field. Marketing ground, primary fills.
on paper 6.94:1 · on clay 1.0:1

--posta-clay-deep
#742F25
Pressed field. The only clay safe for gold text.
on paper 8.98:1 · on clay 1.29:1

--posta-clay-tint
#F2E2DA
Selected chip, quiet fill.
on paper 1.17:1 · on clay 5.92:1

--posta-cream
#F7EDE2
Type on the field.
on paper 1.08:1 · on clay 6.45:1

--posta-paper
#FBF6EF
The app background.
on paper 1.0:1 · on clay 6.94:1

--posta-ink
#24140F
All body type on light.
on paper 16.52:1 · on clay 2.38:1

--posta-ink-soft
#6E5B4E
Secondary text, meta.
on paper 5.97:1 · on clay 1.16:1

--posta-gold
#E9A93C
The single accent. Once per screen.
on paper 1.91:1 · on clay 3.63:1

--posta-line
#EADCCB
Hairlines only.
on paper 1.25:1 · on clay 5.54:1

State colours — functional, never decorative

--posta-success
#2F6B4F
on paper 5.85:1

--posta-danger
#A32B22
on paper 6.67:1

--posta-warning
#8A5A12
on paper 5.5:1

The gold rules

- Ink on gold 8.63:1 — the primary button, that is the job
- Gold on clay 3.63:1 — large text or graphics only
- Gold on paper 1.91:1 — **never** text, hairline or focus ring
- One gold element per screen. Two means do neither

Corrected in this version

- Warning was #B5761A at 3.51:1 on paper — failed AA, now #8A5A12 at 5.50:1
- Focus rings are per surface: clay on light (6.94:1), cream on clay (6.45:1)
- Gold as a focus ring was invisible on paper, which is why it is banned

Space Grotesk for display, Inter for reading — ten sizes, 11px floor

display 96px · 700 · lh 0.95 · tracking -0.03em	Write it once.
h1 48px · 700 · lh 1.15 · tracking -0.02em	Tuesday's posts
h2 32px · 700 · lh 1.15 · tracking -0.01em	Ready to approve
h3 22px · 500 · lh 1.25	IsiZulu draft
body-lg 18px · 400 · lh 1.55	Posta writes it in the language your customer thinks in.
body 16px · 400 · lh 1.55	The default size for everything in the app.
small 14px · 400 · lh 1.5	Secondary text and table cells.
meta 12px · 500 · lh 1.4 · tracking 0.16em	SCHEDULED · 17:30 SAST
micro 11px · 500 · lh 1.4 · tracking 0.1em	11px is the floor. Nothing smaller.

COMPONENTS

Every state, because the missing ones are what feel unfinished

Button

Approve and schedule

Hover

Focus

Disabled

Secondary

Quiet action

Field

EMAIL ADDRESS

you@yourbusiness.co.za

EMAIL ADDRESS

thabo@

That address is missing an @domain.

The post card — the component the product exists for

ISIZULU INSTAGRAM 07:00 SAST

“Isinkwa esisha siphuma ngo-7. Woza masinyane — amavetkoek aphela ngokushesha.”

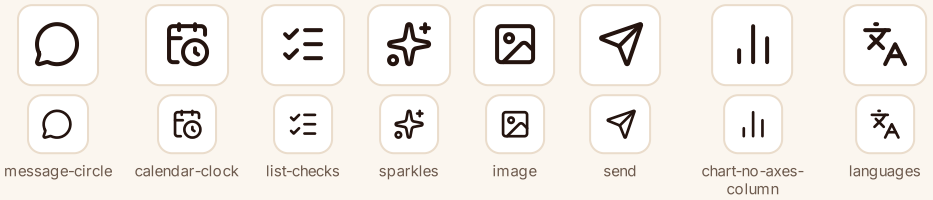
Approve Edit SCHEDULED

A failed post always says why and what to do: “Instagram rejected the image: 9MB, the limit is 8MB.” Never “something went wrong”.

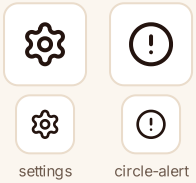
ICONS AND ILLUSTRATION

The rule is size, not taste

Lucide — the interface. 16–24px, stroke 2



message-circle · calendar-clock · list-checks · sparkles · image · send · chart-no-axes-column · languages



settings · circle-alert

ISC licence, 2,171 icons, installs from npm. One stroke weight so the set stays even as it shrinks. This is what lives in a sidebar, a toolbar and a table.

Doodle Icons — illustration. 32px and up



message · calendar · photo · megaphone · magic-wand · trophy

CC0, 451 SVGs. Charming and hand-drawn, which is the brand voice. They are **filled paths, not strokes**: measured at 24px they go chunky, and at 16px the calendar becomes a square and the gear becomes a lump. So they illustrate, they never operate the UI.

Never

- An emoji used as an icon
- A doodle in a toolbar or a table
- A stock speech bubble as the logo
- Two stroke weights on one screen

Always

- Lucide under 32px, doodles at 32px and above
- An icon with a label, or an aria-label
- Official brand marks for Instagram, Facebook, X and LinkedIn
- One icon weight per view

VOICE, AND THE RULES THAT OVERRIDE IT

Warm, direct, competent. Never performing.

How it sounds

- Speaks to **you**, not “users”
- SA English: organise, colour, centre
- Rands as **R299**. Times as **17:30 SAST**, 24-hour
- Language names in their own language: isiZulu, Sesotho, Afrikaans
- “No posts scheduled yet. Pick a day and Posta will draft three.”

Banned words

- oops, whoops, simply, just, easily
- revolutionary, game-changing, seamless, effortless, unlock

Honesty rules — these override tone

- **Never claim a number we cannot show.** The old front page said “5,000+ SA businesses” with zero customers. It is gone.
- **Never invent a testimonial.** Three were live from demo personas. Gone.
- **Never claim a capability that is not built.** “Coming soon” is honest.
- **Name the limit:** “Free plan: 10 credits, 5 scheduled posts.”
- **Errors state the cause and the fix.** Never “something went wrong”.
- **Do not claim load-shedding resilience.** Eskom reported 500+ days without load-shedding on 2 Oct 2026.